

PROGRAMME ASSESSMENT

IndiaFOSS 2026 Conference Programme Analysis

A structural assessment of the scheduled conference programme — what it covers well, where it thins out, and what a wholesome FOSS & digital-commons programme would still need.



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137

SCHEDULED
SESSIONS

68.3h

PROGRAMME
MINUTES

10

TRACKS /
DEVROOMS

3

CONFERENCE
DAYS

Source: if2026-schedule.ods (General Track + 8 devrooms) plus the 8 pre-conference Workshop proposals from cfp-all.csv (approx. 2 hours each, held the day before the main conference), cross-referenced against the published CFP proposals at fossunited.org/c/indiafoss/2026/cfp, the FOSS United forum's devroom/BoF/panel call threads, and the public 75-booth listing at fossunited.org/indiafoss/2026/booths.

Executive Summary

IndiaFOSS 2026's programme is **large, technically serious, and unusually community-minded**. Counting the pre-conference workshop day, the conference runs **137 sessions across roughly 68 hours** over three days, and builds its identity around four consistent pillars: a deep **systems/embedded engineering** cluster (Android internals, RTOS, compilers, open hardware, security), a broad **FOSS community & civic-commons** strand running through the General Track (contributor culture, GovTech, digital public goods, policy), a full dedicated **Documentation & Technical Writing** devroom — a track most conferences of this size skip entirely — and a **pre-conference workshop day** that gives eight topics a genuinely hands-on, 2-hour treatment. Average technical depth (5.7/10) and novelty (5.6/10) sit in a healthy "practitioner-intermediate" band: this is a conference of people telling war stories from real, shipped systems, not a research symposium and not a beginner bootcamp. That community-mindedness shows up in the numbers, too: 157 named speakers plus a 75-booth community floor put roughly 1 "producer" in the room for every 7–8 of the 2,383 registered attendees (Section 10) — an unusually dense participation rate next to most technology conferences.

The programme is also **lopsided in three predictable ways**: within the two main conference days, format skews heavily toward short exposure (43% of all sessions are 15-minute-or-under lightning talks) at the expense of sustained depth; content skews toward the **application layer** even inside "systems" tracks; and the eight workshops, while a genuine strength, sit thematically apart from the conference's own technical core — none of them extend the RTOS, AOSP, Hardware, Compilers or Security devrooms into hands-on territory. Several other large, active areas of the FOSS/digital-commons world — data engineering & ML systems, accessibility, and full-stack open hardware beyond firmware — remain present only as a trace rather than as first-class content.

A note on who curates what

IndiaFOSS's programme has two different governance layers, and the gap analysis below is only fair if it's read with this split in mind. The **General Track — including its Talks, BoFs and Panels, and the pre-conference Workshop day — is curated directly by IndiaFOSS's own Programme Committee (PC)** from individual open proposals. The **8 devrooms (AOSP, Compilers, Documentation & Technical Writing, Cloud & DevOps, RTOS, Security, Design, Hardware) are each organised independently**, who pick their own speakers and run their own internal review — but **which devrooms exist at all was itself a PC decision**: 12 devroom proposals were submitted to an open call, and the PC selected 8. BoF and Panel topics went through the same open-call-then-PC-selection model. "Independently organised" isn't uniform, though: only **3 of the 8 devrooms are run by an established, named community** — Cloud & DevOps by Point Blank (who also handle a good chunk of the conference's on-ground volunteering), Compilers by LLVM Social Bangalore, and Hardware by absurd.industries — all three of whom are also listed as conference Community Partners. AOSP is a borderline case, led by a couple of individuals from the aosp-devs.org community. The remaining four — Documentation & Technical Writing, RTOS, Security, and Design — are run by individual volunteer organisers rather than a standing community or group. So a thin devroom (Hardware, at 6 sessions) is a signal about one organisation's bandwidth as much as community turnout — absurd.industries is simultaneously a Community Partner, this devroom's curator, and a booth exhibitor (Section 9), which is a lot of hats for one team. And **a topic area with no devroom at all may mean a proposal for it**

existed and the PC didn't select it — which is exactly what happened for two of the gaps below. The tags mark which layer each gap sits in; where a specific rejected proposal is known, it's named.

Gap analysis — at a glance

• Well represented

- **INDEPENDENT DEVROOM** **Embedded systems depth** — AOSP + RTOS + Compilers + Hardware + Security together contribute 885 minutes of high-depth content (avg. depth 5.8–7.6/10), the technical core of the conference — run independently of the PC either way, though only Compilers and Hardware are backed by a standing named community (LLVM Social Bangalore, absurd.industries); RTOS and Security are individual-organiser devrooms and AOSP is a borderline case.
- **BOTH LAYERS** **FOSS community & contribution culture** — 74 of 137 sessions touch "Community" as a domain; onboarding, maintainership, and governance are recurring threads in both the PC's General Track and the devrooms.
- **INDEPENDENT DEVROOM** **Documentation as a first-class discipline** — a full 11-session, 150-minute devroom, rare at this scale, and notably run by individual volunteer organisers rather than a standing community — a whole devroom's worth of quality without an established organisation behind it.
- **PROGRAMME COMMITTEE** **A genuine hands-on workshop day** — 8 pre-conference workshops (2 hours each, 960 minutes total) on Qt, OCaml, generative art/live-coding, AI agents, OpenStreetMap mapping, self-hosting, and digital security give real skill-building a dedicated day rather than a token slot.
- **PROGRAMME COMMITTEE** **Civic tech / GovTech / digital-commons data** — judiciary mapping, GovTech archives, water intelligence, census/data-for-India work form a coherent public-interest thread inside the General Track.
- **INDEPENDENT DEVROOM** **Compiler & PL depth** — LLVM, formal verification, Rust, Julia, WASM:

• Thin or missing

- **PROGRAMME COMMITTEE** **Workshops don't reach the conference's own technical core** — the 8 hands-on sessions (a Programme Committee-curated surface, same as the General Track) skew toward general-purpose software, creative-coding and civic themes; none is a hands-on extension of RTOS, AOSP, Hardware, Compilers or Security — the very devrooms with the highest average depth (5.8–7.6/10) get zero hands-on treatment, even though the PC clearly knows how to run a good workshop.
- **PROGRAMME COMMITTEE** **Data & AI systems have no home track — and it's not for lack of proposals** — a "Building with Open Data in India" devroom was proposed to the open call and **not selected** (8 of 12 proposals made it through); at the panel level, 2 of the 3 publicly-rejected panel proposals were AI-focused ("Building a Global AI Commons" and "Who Pays for Cognition? Open Source in the Age of Organization-Hosted AI Agents"). What AI content survived (~20 sessions) sits scattered inside the PC's own General Track, Workshop day, Cloud & DevOps and Compilers. The demand was there; the PC's selection process is where it didn't make the cut. *Partially offset by 5 data-focused community booths — see §9.*
- **INDEPENDENT DEVROOM** **Open hardware beyond firmware is the smallest devroom** — only 6 sessions / 175 minutes, dwarfed by the software-adjacent embedded tracks (RTOS 10, AOSP 11). It's run by absurd.industries, who are simultaneously a conference Community Partner and a booth exhibitor (Section 9) — this reads less like weak community interest and more like one organisation carrying the whole devroom on top of its other conference commitments, not a Programme Committee decision. *Partially offset*

a genuine deep-tech devroom, run by LLVM Social Bangalore, one of the conference's own Community Partners.

by 6 hardware-focused community booths, roughly matching the devroom's own session count — see §9.

- **PROGRAMME COMMITTEE** **Policy & legal depth is shallow — a dedicated devroom for it was proposed and rejected** — a "Tech Geopolitics and Policy" devroom (digital sovereignty, trade policy, sanctions, regional FOSS adoption) was among the 4 of 12 proposals the PC didn't select. What's left is 12 of 13 Legal/Policy sessions sitting inside the PC's own General Track or Workshop day, almost all as 15-minute lightning talks or BoFs; software patents, age-verification law, and content regulation get exposure, not sustained treatment. *Partially offset by 4 policy/legal community booths (SFLC.in, Constitutional Observer, Takshashila, DAKSH)* — see §9.
- **PROGRAMME COMMITTEE** **Two more proposed devrooms didn't make the cut either** — "Open Cellular Communication" (open-source telecom/5G, Open RAN) and "FOSS at the Edge of Experience" (creative coding, games, interactive/spatial computing) were both submitted to the same open call and not selected, alongside the Data and Policy proposals above. Only 8 of 12 devroom pitches were accepted.
- **BOTH LAYERS** **Accessibility, localisation and inclusive design** appear only incidentally, split evenly between the PC's General Track and the community-curated Documentation devroom (one Tamil-translation talk each side) — thin everywhere, not one layer's gap to close alone.
- **PROGRAMME COMMITTEE** **Sustainability/business-model-of-FOSS content is discussion-only** — pay competitiveness, cooperatives, and monetisation are raised in General Track BoFs (60-minute, unstructured) rather than researched talks.
- **WHO ATTENDS** **The conference itself is regionally concentrated** — of 2,383 registered attendees, Karnataka and Kerala alone are 44%, and the five South Indian states together are roughly 58% (Section 10). Not a programming-

content gap, but a real limit on how "pan-India" the event's reach currently is — worth reading alongside the topical gaps above.

Net assessment

The programme is **wholesome for a systems-and-community-minded FOSS audience** — a software developer, embedded engineer, or community organiser will find a full three days of relevant, well-paced content, including genuine hands-on time on the workshop day. It is **less wholesome for a data/AI practitioner, a hardware maker beyond firmware, or a policy specialist wanting depth** — and the one attendee still under-served on the skill-building front is exactly the person the deep-tech devrooms attract: someone who came for RTOS, AOSP, Hardware, Compilers or Security gets zero hands-on options in their own area, even though the workshop day proves the organisers know how to run one. Read against the two curation layers, essentially **every gap here traces back to the Programme Committee's own selection decisions**, not to community indifference: the workshop/depth-track mismatch and the General Track's shallow policy treatment are direct PC curation choices, and — now that the devroom call-for-proposals record is public — so is the absence of Data, Policy, Telecom and Creative-Experience devrooms, all four of which were proposed by name and turned down alongside the 8 that were accepted. The honest framing isn't "no community has organised this yet" — it's "the PC had it on the table and chose 8 other things instead," which is a reasonable, resource-constrained call to make, but a different one than "this part of FOSS doesn't have a community behind it in India." And it's worth remembering the talk programme isn't the whole conference: the 75-booth community floor (Section 9) gives the Data, Policy and Hardware communities a real, staffed presence even without a stage — an attendee who wants to find them just has to walk the floor instead of sitting in a session.

Detailed Overview

1. How the programme is built — and who curates it

The schedule has three layers, and critically, two different curators. A **pre-conference Workshop day** (8 sessions, 960 minutes) runs the day before the main event, each workshop given a full 2-hour hands-on slot. Then, across the two main conference days, the **General Track** (54 sessions, 1,800 minutes — 44% of all programme time) runs across three halls and rooms and is the conference's broadest surface: general FOSS talks, an invited talk, two panel discussions, and eight BoFs sit alongside standard 30-minute talks. Both the General Track and the Workshop day are curated centrally by **IndiaFOSS's own Programme Committee** — every gap or strength found there is a direct reflection of the PC's own editorial choices. The remaining eight sheets are **half-day mini-conferences ("devrooms")** — AOSP, Compilers, Documentation & Technical Writing, Cloud & DevOps, RTOS, Security, Design, and Hardware — each concentrated into a single afternoon or morning block on one day, in a single room, and each **organised independently**, setting its own scope, review, and session count. That independence takes two different shapes, though: **Cloud & DevOps, Compilers and Hardware are each run by an established, named community** (Point Blank, LLVM Social Bangalore, and absurd.industries respectively — all three also listed as conference Community Partners, with Point Blank additionally handling much of the on-ground volunteering), **AOSP is led by a couple of individuals from the aosp-devs.org community**, and **Documentation & Technical Writing, RTOS, Security and Design are each run by individual volunteer organisers** rather than a standing group. Devrooms together contribute 75 sessions and 1,340 minutes (33%). This structure means a single attendee physically cannot sample more than a handful of devrooms across the two days, so the devroom line-up functions less like "an even split" and more like eight parallel mini-conferences that different sub-communities self-select into and self-organise — with the workshop day functioning as a distinct, opt-in fourth event, back under the PC's own curation.

2. Format and duration: breadth over depth on the main days

Of the 129 sessions across the two main conference days, **59 (46%) are lightning talks of 15 minutes or less**, and **56 (43%) are standard 20–30 minute talks**. Only 12 sessions run 60 minutes or longer, and those are almost entirely BoFs and panel discussions (open-floor formats), not deep single-speaker technical dives — there is effectively no 60-minute solo deep-technical talk slot anywhere in the two-day programme. Two devrooms — **Cloud & DevOps and RTOS** — are **90% lightning talks**, meaning attendees get rapid exposure to many ideas (10 topics in roughly 2.5 hours each) but little room for any single idea to be explored past its motivating problem. By contrast, **Hardware and Design run zero lightning talks** — every session there gets at least 20 minutes, and it shows in the narrative completeness of those proposals. This is a real editorial trade-off already made by the programme committee: devrooms with the most novel/frontier material (RTOS, avg. novelty 6.5/10) are also the ones giving each idea the least time to land. The workshop day is the counterweight to all of this: its 8 sessions are uniformly 120 minutes, the longest, most sustained format anywhere in the conference.

3. What kind of work is this? Overall category and stack level

By minutes across all 137 sessions, the programme splits **Software 2,030 min (50%) · FOSS Philosophy/Principles 1,220 min (30%) · Data 520 min (13%) · Hardware 330 min (8%)**. Nearly a third of scheduled time goes to community, governance, culture, policy and career topics rather than shipped technical artefacts — a signal that IndiaFOSS positions itself as a movement-building conference as much as a technical one. Within the technical stack-level tags, **"Application" dominates at 91 tag-instances**, far

ahead of Frameworks/Middleware (20), Firmware (17), Operating System (16), Libraries (12), Hardware (9) and Kernel (7) — even the RTOS and AOSP devrooms, nominally "systems" tracks, spend much of their time at the firmware/application boundary (bootloaders, HALs, drivers) rather than deep kernel or silicon work. Genuine kernel- and silicon-level content (RISC-V crypto acceleration, TriCore bring-up, HackerFab semiconductor fabrication, sandbox kernels) exists but is a minority inside a minority, and the workshop day — being introductory by design — adds to the application-layer weight rather than the kernel/hardware end.

4. Domains served

Tagged against the domains in *categories.md*, sessions cluster heavily around **Community (74)** and **Industry (57)**, with **Research (27)**, **Education/Academia (19)**, **Not-for-Profit (17)**, **Government (14)** and **Legal/Policy (13)** trailing well behind (sessions can carry more than one domain tag). Government and civic-tech content is real and often high-quality — the Telangana Oracle-to-PostgreSQL migration, the NHA AI-workflow talk, the Judiciary Entity Map, the CBSE exam-security disclosure story — but at 14 tagged sessions it is a minor thread relative to the scale of India's GovTech/DPI ecosystem that FOSS United's own General-Track panel ("From DPI to People's Digital Infrastructure") explicitly calls out as underserved. Education/Academia content gets a boost from the workshop day (Qt, OCaml and generative-art workshops are explicitly pitched at learners) but is still sparse given how much of the FOSS pipeline (GSoC, campus communities, COSH-style centres) depends on it.

5. Depth vs. novelty, and who the programme is for

Across all 137 sessions, average depth is **5.7/10** and average novelty **5.6/10**, with RTOS (7.6 depth) and Security (6.8 depth) the deepest tracks, and the Workshop day (4.6 depth, by design — these are onboarding sessions for newcomers) and Documentation & Technical Writing (4.5 depth) intentionally the most accessible. The dashboard below breaks depth vs. novelty out by overall category: Hardware sessions cluster at high depth/high novelty (little hand-holding, aimed at practitioners already in the space), while FOSS Philosophy/Principles sessions cluster at low-to-mid depth (accessible almost by design, since the goal is persuasion and culture-building rather than technique transfer). Audience tags mirror this: **software developers are the explicit or implicit audience for 98 of 137 sessions**, with professionals (52), researchers (38) and hackers (37) next; educators/professors (13) and designers (10) are the least served named audiences from the *categories.md* list, and **venture capitalists are the one named audience with zero sessions** (business people fare little better, at 13, none of them addressed primarily to a funding/investment audience). Two sessions were precise enough to earn an audience tag beyond the eleven named examples — "community organizers" and "community" itself — which *categories.md*'s own "etc." explicitly allows.

IndiaFOSS 2026 — Programme at a Glance

137 scheduled sessions (incl. pre-conference workshops) · 4,100 minutes · 10 tracks
(PC) = curated by the Programme Committee · (dev) = independently curated devroom

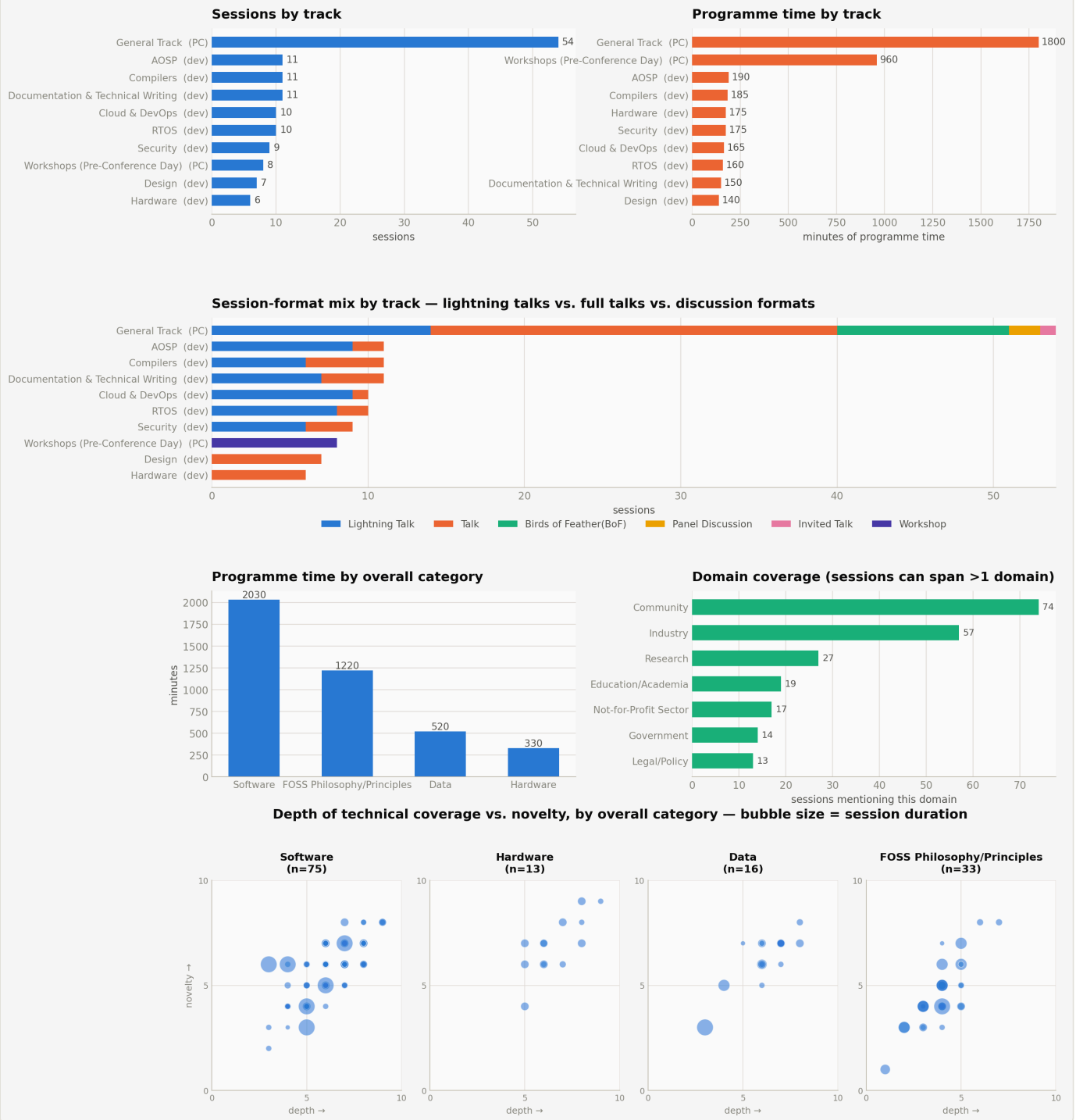


Figure 1. Programme composition across the six metrics tracked in this assessment: session and time distribution by track (including the pre-conference Workshop day), format mix, overall-category time split, domain coverage, and the depth/novelty relationship by category (bubble size = session duration in minutes). Track labels in the top two panels and the format-mix chart are tagged **(PC)** for the Programme Committee-curated surface (General Track + Workshops) and **(dev)** for the 8 independently-curated devrooms.

6. The ambient-AI observation

No track or devroom is named for AI or machine learning, yet AI/agent-related themes surface in roughly a quarter of the programme by scheduled minutes — sandboxing AI agents, AI on-call agents, KV-cache systems work, AI-driven language assessment, AI evaluation frameworks for non-profits, one full hands-on

workshop on building AI agents, and multiple policy sessions on AI-generated imagery and open-weight model harms. This is arguably the right editorial call for a conference about *Free and Open Source Software* rather than AI specifically — but it also means attendees looking for a coherent "open/local AI systems" thread have to assemble it themselves from talks and one workshop scattered across five unrelated tracks.

7. The pre-conference workshops, in detail

The 8 workshops are: *Getting Started with Qt* (desktop GUI development), *Making Music with strudel.cc* (live-coding, complete-beginner friendly), *Digital Security for Journalists, Activists, and Everyday Internet Users* (privacy/threat-modelling), *Fun and Profit with OCaml* (functional programming, run by IIT Madras's FP Launchpad), *Art – meet Math – meet Code* (generative art with p5.js), *Building AI Agents End-to-End* (agent frameworks, MCP, observability), *Adding Places to OpenStreetMap* (an outdoor mapping session), and *Self-Hosting 101* (homelab/server setup). Read as a set, this is a genuinely well-rounded introductory slate — it spans desktop software, functional programming, civic mapping, digital rights, creative coding, and modern AI tooling, and three of the eight (strudel.cc, Art/Math/Code, OpenStreetMap) are explicitly designed for participants with no prior programming background, which is rare generosity in a conference this technical. The gap is thematic rather than qualitative: an attendee who wants to walk in the door already excited about RTOS, embedded Android, compilers, open hardware or security has no equivalent hands-on on-ramp — every one of those devrooms remains talk-only, even though the organisers have clearly demonstrated, via the other eight workshops, that they can run a hands-on session well.

8. What didn't make it: the proposals the Programme Committee turned down

IndiaFOSS runs its devrooms, BoFs and panels through open public calls on the FOSS United forum, and the PC's own selection threads are public — which means this report can name specific rejected proposals rather than just inferring gaps from what's missing. **Devrooms:** 12 proposals were submitted to the March–May 2026 call-for-devrooms; the PC selected 8 (AOSP, Compilers, Documentation & Technical Writing, Cloud & DevOps, RTOS, Security, Design, Hardware) and turned down 4 — *Tech Geopolitics and Policy* (digital sovereignty, trade policy, regional FOSS adoption), *Building with Open Data in India* (climate-tech and civic-tech data quality), *Open Cellular Communication* (open-source 5G/Open RAN telecom), and *FOSS at the Edge of Experience* (creative coding, games, spatial computing). **Panels:** at least 5 were proposed for 2 slots; of the 3 unsuccessful proposals visible on the forum, 2 were explicitly AI-focused — *Building a Global AI Commons* and *Who Pays for Cognition? Open Source in the Age of Organization-Hosted AI Agents* — alongside *Community Infrastructure Matters: Scaling People Like We Scale Platforms*. **BoFs:** 20 topics were publicly proposed for the 11 BoF slots that made the final schedule; the thread doesn't mark rejections explicitly, so which 9 didn't make it isn't confirmed, though topics visible in the proposal thread but absent from the final programme include *Open Source in Education*, *AI-Driven Development Practices*, *FOSS Licensing Fundamentals*, and *Decentralization and Digital Privacy*.

Read together, this changes the shape of the gap analysis on page 2: the Data, Policy, Telecom and Creative-Experience gaps aren't blind spots nobody in India's FOSS community cares about — they're topics with organised advocates who put together a full devroom pitch and lost out in a competitive selection process, most likely on capacity grounds (8 of 12 is already a lot of parallel programming for a two-day conference). The AI panel proposals tell a similar story at smaller scale. None of this is a criticism of any single decision — a PC has to say no to good proposals every year — but it does mean the honest gap-analysis framing is "proposed and not selected," not "absent from the community."

9. Beyond the talks: the booth floor and sponsors

Everything above is about the *talk* programme. IndiaFOSS also runs a **75-booth community floor** (fossunited.org/indiafoss/2026/booths) — tables staffed by two representatives each, running one or both days, where projects and communities demo work and talk to attendees directly rather than present from a stage. The public listing groups them as FOSS Project (27), Community (29), Hardware (6), Student-led community/project (6), and a thematic "All Things Open" cluster (7); 55 of the 75 run both days.

The booth floor materially **offsets three of the session-level gaps above** — worth weighing before concluding a topic is genuinely absent from the conference. **Open hardware** gets real floor presence beyond the small devroom: absurd.industries, Ampere Works, PCB Cupid, Pling! (an open-source keyboard), T-01 The Explorer (robotics), and GOSH (Global Open Science Hardware) — six hardware-focused tables, roughly matching the devroom's own session count. **Policy & legal**, shut out at both the devroom and panel level, still shows up as SFLC.in (software freedom legal advocacy), Constitutional Observer, Takshashila Institution, and DAKSH & the Judicial Data Collaborative — four booths doing exactly the sustained policy work the talk programme couldn't fit in. **Data & civic-data** — the rejected devroom's actual subject — gets Data For India, Open Data Kerala, Samaajdata, OpenCity, and API Dash. What the booth floor does *not* reach: nothing in the list is disability-accessibility-focused (a few booths touch language localisation instead — Indic MediaWiki Developers, Sanchaya/ServantsOfKnowledge, Wikimedians of Kerala — which is a related but distinct gap), and nothing revisits the rejected Telecom or Creative-Experience devroom pitches beyond one mesh-networking booth (Janastu Anthillhacks).

Separately, IndiaFOSS lists **10 sponsors** (Samagata Foundation, Zerodha, Frappe, Bruno, Ente, Red Hat, Tangled, Juspay Hyperswitch, Mecha Systems, Grafana) plus **3 named community partners** (Point Blank, absurd.industries, LLVM Social Bangalore) on the conference's main page — logos and hyperlinks only, no talk slot attached, so they sit outside this report's session-by-session classification entirely. They're a rough proxy for who's funding the event rather than what it covers: several (Frappe, Grafana, Red Hat, Juspay) map straight onto the programme's already-strong Cloud/DevOps and enterprise-software content, and two (Mecha Systems, absurd.industries) also appear as speakers or booth exhibitors in the sections above — sponsorship and content aren't fully separate worlds here, but the sponsor list doesn't meaningfully shift any of the gap findings.

10. Who's in the room: attendee stats and the producer-to-attendee ratio

IndiaFOSS's own public dashboard (fossunited.org/indiafoss/2026/stats) reports **2,383 total registrations**. The five ticket tiers it breaks out — Students (751), Enthusiast (478), Late Bird Enthusiast (230), Regular (130), and Contributor (34) — sum to only 1,623, about 760 short of that headline total; the dashboard doesn't itemise what the remaining ~32% is (most plausibly complimentary or non-tiered passes — speakers, volunteers, sponsor teams — but this report can't confirm that from the public page alone). Gender skews heavily male (1,185 / 75%, vs. 360 / 23% women, with the remainder non-binary or undisclosed), and geography skews heavily South Indian: Karnataka (595) and Kerala (458) alone are 44% of all registrations, and Karnataka + Kerala + Tamil Nadu + Andhra Pradesh + Telangana together account for roughly 58% — this reads much more as a Bangalore-region flagship event than a evenly-distributed pan-India one, worth naming plainly alongside the topical gaps when asking "wholesome for whom."

Speakers and community booths are usefully thought of as the conference's "producers", with everyone else as attendees. This report can put a real number on that ratio rather than guess at it, because every one of the 137 session pages fetched for this analysis also lists its speakers by name: pulling that field out gives **157 unique named speakers** across the talk programme (170 speaker-slots total, since 13 people speak twice). Add the 75-booth floor at two representatives each (150 more producer seats, per how each booth is

staffed) and the upper-bound producer count is **~307** — against 2,383 registered attendees, that's **roughly 1 producer for every 7–8 attendees, or about 13% of the room**. That number can only be a ceiling, not an exact headcount: there's no way to check whether a booth's two named representatives are also a session speaker, and 150 assumes every booth keeps the same two people the whole time rather than rotating volunteers. Even discounted, this is a strikingly dense participation rate for a conference this size — most technology conferences run closer to one speaker for every 30–50+ attendees. It's the clearest quantitative evidence in this whole report for the "unusually community-minded" read that runs through it: a meaningful share of the people at IndiaFOSS aren't just watching, they're also running something.

Full Session Metrics Table

All 129 scheduled sessions, classified against the *categories.md* schema: Platform, Domain, Level in Technology Stack, Overall category, Depth of technical coverage (1–10), Novelty vs. existing work (1–10), and Suitability for audience. Sessions are grouped by track, then by scheduled time. Title links to the original CFP proposal on fossunited.org. Multi-value fields are separated by “;”.

Track	Session	When	Min	Format	Platform	Domain	Stack Level	Category	Depth	Novelty	Audience
AOSP	Keeping up with the AOSP	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	10	Lightning Talk	Mobile	Community;Industry	Operating System	Software	4	3	software developers, professionals
AOSP	Under the Hood of Android , What Really Happens When You Open an App?	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Mobile	Education/Academia;Community	Operating System	Software	5	4	software developers, graduate/master students
AOSP	Launcher3 Internals: Understanding Android's Home Screen, Google Feed Integration, and Custom -1 Panels	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	25	Lightning Talk	Mobile	Community;Industry	Application	Software	6	6	software developers, professionals
AOSP	Inside Android Keyboards: Building an Open Source IME	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Mobile	Community	Application;Frameworks/Middleware	Software	6	6	software developers, hackers
AOSP	Adapting Generic Boot Loader on Android Platforms	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Embedded;Mobile	Industry	Firmware;Operating System	Software	8	7	software developers, professionals
AOSP	Porting AOSP to Allwinner Sunxi platform	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	25	Talk	Embedded;Mobile	Community;Industry	Kernel;Operating System	Software	9	8	software developers, hackers, professionals
AOSP	Living With a DeGoogled Phone: Privacy, Trade-offs, and Daily Use	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Mobile	Community	Application	Software	3	3	hackers, social workers
AOSP	Volume Controller using Knob (Potentiometer)	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Embedded;Mobile	Community;Education/Academia	Hardware;Firmware	Hardware	6	6	hackers, graduate/master students
AOSP	Zero Trust, Zero TEE: Porting Android 16 to a Device Whose Security Stack Doesn't Exist Yet	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Mobile	Community;Industry	Kernel;Operating System	Software	9	8	software developers, professionals, hackers
AOSP	Beyond HIDL: Modernizing Android HALs with Rust & Stable AIDL	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	25	Talk	Mobile	Industry	Operating System;Frameworks/Middleware	Software	8	6	software developers, professionals
AOSP	Bypassing Android MTP: pushing a native C++ daemon via ADB for fast storage analysis	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Mobile;Desktop	Community	Application	Software	6	7	software developers, hackers
Cloud & DevOps	How OpenTelemetry Instrumentation Works Under the Hood	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cloud/Server	Industry	Libraries;Frameworks/Middleware	Software	7	5	software developers, professionals
Cloud & DevOps	Remote Execution by Design: Sandboxing AI Agents with gVisor & Pipelock	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	30	Talk	Cloud/Server	Industry;Research	Kernel;Operating System	Software	8	7	software developers, professionals, researchers
Cloud & DevOps	From Prompts to Production: Building an Open-Source AI On-Call Agent with MCP and Multi-Agent Workflows	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cloud/Server	Industry	Frameworks/Middleware;Application	Software	6	5	software developers, professionals
Cloud & DevOps	Long live outbox : Outbox is dead	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cloud/Server	Industry	Libraries;Application	Software	7	6	software developers, professionals
Cloud & DevOps	Kubernetes Native Observability Dashboards with Perseus, without the YAML/JSON Hell	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cloud/Server	Industry;Community	Frameworks/Middleware;Application	Software	6	6	software developers, professionals
Cloud & DevOps	Cilium Network Policy Anti-Patterns I Learned the Hard Way	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cloud/Server	Industry	Frameworks/Middleware	Software	6	4	software developers, professionals
Cloud & DevOps	Escaping Cron Hell: Building and Contributing to Dagou, an Open Source Workflow Orchestrator	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cloud/Server	Community;Industry	Application	Software	5	5	software developers, professionals
Cloud & DevOps	15 Years, One Server, 8GB RAM and 500,000 Linux Learners: Lessons from Running Webminal	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Web	Education/Academia;Not-for-Profit Sector	Application	Software	4	6	educators/professors, graduate/master students, social workers
Cloud & DevOps	Unused Is Not a Kubernetes Field: Platform Hygiene Is Not Cleanup	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cloud/Server	Industry	Application	Software	5	4	software developers, professionals
Cloud & DevOps	I Deleted Production With helm upgrade. Here's the Exact Chain of Events.	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cloud/Server	Industry	Application	Software	5	4	software developers, professionals

Track	Session	When	Min	Format	Platform	Domain	Stack Level	Category	Depth	Novelt y	Audience
Compilers	Semantic Quantization in KV Cache Eviction	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cross-platform	Research;Industry	Frameworks/Middle ware	Software	8	8	researchers, software developers
Compilers	Databases in Ethereum Nodes	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cross-platform	Research;Industry	Libraries	Data	7	6	software developers, researchers
Compilers	Bend, don't Break. Modern Techniques for Flexibility in Strongly Typed Functional Programming	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	20	Talk	Cross-platform	Community;Research	Libraries	Software	7	5	software developers, researchers
Compilers	PeerDAS: Erasure Coding When You Can't Trust the Storage	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	20	Talk	Cross-platform	Research;Industry	Libraries	Data	8	8	researchers, software developers
Compilers	Benchmarking can be hard, here's why we're still creating a new one for OCaml	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cross-platform	Research	Libraries	Software	5	4	researchers, software developers
Compilers	What LLVM Does Differently When The Target Is CPU VS GPU	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cross-platform	Industry;Research	Frameworks/Middle ware	Software	8	6	software developers, researchers
Compilers	PythonBPF - now with loops, custom funcs, and more maps!	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Talk	Cross-platform	Community;Industry	Kernel;Libraries	Software	7	7	software developers, hackers
Compilers	LGTM Is Not A Theorem	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cross-platform	Industry	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Princ iples	4	3	software developers, professionals
Compilers	One Language, All GPU: How Julia Targets different GPU backends from a Single Kernel.	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Cross-platform	Research;Community	Frameworks/Middle ware	Software	7	7	researchers, software developers
Compilers	Rust Is Not an HDL, So I Built a Tiny One.	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	20	Talk	Desktop	Community	Frameworks/Middle ware	Software	6	6	software developers, hackers
Compilers	Formal Verification: An Introduction through Elementary Arithmetic	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 14:00	20	Talk	Cross-platform	Education/Academia;Re search	Application	Software	5	5	graduate/master students, researchers, educators/professors
Design	Forkable design	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	20	Talk	Web;Cross- platform	Industry	Application	Software	5	5	designers, software developers, business people
Design	Shaili Sanchaya: Reviving Indic Typography from Archival Metadata	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	20	Talk	Web	Community;Not-for-Profit Sector	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Princ iples	7	8	designers, researchers, educators/professors
Design	Designing for Reality: Where UI Meets the Physical World	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	20	Talk	Cross-platform	Industry	Application	Software	4	4	designers
Design	Creating Design Systems in p5JS to accelerate Content Creation	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	20	Talk	Web	Industry;Community	Application	Software	5	6	designers, software developers, business people
Design	KaiOS Design Notes: UX observations from a feature phone	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	20	Talk	Mobile	Community	Application	Software	5	6	designers, hackers
Design	Making Desktops Expressive: Introducing Bézier Curves to GTK	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	20	Talk	Desktop	Community	Frameworks/Middle ware;Application	Software	6	6	designers, software developers
Design	Sound Is All You Need: From Good UX to Great UX	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	20	Talk	Cross-platform	Industry	Application	Software	4	5	designers
Documentation & Technical Writing	Your first open source contribution does not have to be code	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	10	Lightning Talk	Web	Community;Not-for-Profit Sector	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Princ iples	3	4	hackers, social workers, graduate/master students
Documentation & Technical Writing	Why Documentation Shouldn't Feel Like Plain Text	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	10	Lightning Talk	Cross-platform	Community;Research	Frameworks/Middle ware	Software	6	7	software developers, researchers
Documentation & Technical Writing	Documentation That Drives OSS Adoption: Lessons From Bruno	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	20	Talk	Web	Industry;Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Princ iples	5	4	software developers, professionals, business people
Documentation & Technical Writing	Ctrl+F for 34 Years of India's GovTech (Building a Public Commons for India's Digital Governance History)	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	10	Lightning Talk	Web	Government;Legal/Polic y	Application	Data	5	7	researchers, government employees, social workers

Track	Session	When	Min	Format	Platform	Domain	Stack Level	Category	Depth	Novelt y	Audience
Documentation & Technical Writing	Developer Experience is the New Open Source Contribution. Here's Why	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	20	Talk	Cross-platform	Industry;Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	5	5	software developers, professionals
Documentation & Technical Writing	Refactoring documentation without breaking it	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	10	Lightning Talk	Web	Community	Application	Software	4	4	software developers, hackers
Documentation & Technical Writing	Changelogs Are Not Enough: Writing Community Memory for Kubernetes	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	10	Lightning Talk	Web	Community;Industry	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	5	software developers, professionals
Documentation & Technical Writing	Writing Docs for Two Readers: Humans and AI Agents	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	20	Talk	Web	Industry;Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	6	8	software developers, professionals
Documentation & Technical Writing	Python Now Speaks Tamil: Getting Official Docs Translated for a Mother Tongue	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	10	Lightning Talk	Cross-platform	Education/Academia;Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	7	educators/professors, graduate/master students, social workers
Documentation & Technical Writing	404: Empathy Not Found	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	20	Talk	Cross-platform	Community;Industry	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	5	software developers, professionals
Documentation & Technical Writing	Printable, Downloadable, Forever: An Ode to Offline Documentation	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 1 · 10:00	10	Lightning Talk	Cross-platform	Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	4	software developers, hackers
General Track	From Pull Requests to Patients: Building Open Healthcare Infrastructure in the Open	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:30	30	Talk	Web	Not-for-Profit Sector;Government	Application	Software	7	6	software developers, professionals, social workers, government employees
General Track	From Institution to Community: Building COSH and a Culture of Open Source	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:30	30	Talk	Web	Education/Academia	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	5	educators/professors, graduate/master students
General Track	Textbooks that run: interactive, zero-install CS education in the browser	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:30	30	Talk	Web	Education/Academia	Application	Software	7	8	educators/professors, graduate/master students, software developers
General Track	Tracking-free and hackable network cameras - powered by libre software	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:30	30	Talk	Embedded	Community	Firmware;Application	Hardware	6	7	hackers, software developers
General Track	Fork Around and Find Out: How I Built a GNOME Extension Used by 200K+ People	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:30	15	Lightning Talk	Desktop	Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	4	hackers, software developers
General Track	It takes a village to raise a repo	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:30	15	Lightning Talk	Cross-platform	Community;Not-for-Profit Sector	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	3	social workers, software developers
General Track	Telling India's story through data	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:30	45	Invited Talk	Web	Research;Community	Application	Data	6	6	researchers, government employees, social workers
General Track	From DPI to People's Digital Infrastructure: Reclaiming Digital Infrastructures for Democratic Accountability	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 1 · 14:30	60	Panel Discussion	Web	Government;Community ;Legal/Policy	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	5	6	government employees, social workers, researchers, professionals
General Track	Building OpenSpeaks tools for language documentation and archiving	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 1 · 14:30	30	Talk	Desktop;Web	Research;Community;Not-for-Profit Sector	Application	Software	6	7	researchers, social workers, software developers
General Track	Open Code, Curated Data: Building Open Water Intelligence for Indian Cities	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 1 · 14:30	30	Talk	Web	Government;Community	Application	Data	7	7	software developers, government employees, researchers
General Track	Building Zasper: Inception to Growth	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	30	Talk	Desktop	Community;Research	Application	Software	6	5	software developers, researchers
General Track	Repub: Launching the Open Post-Processing Workflow for Digital Archiving in India	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	30	Talk	Web;Desktop	Not-for-Profit Sector;Community	Application	Data	6	7	social workers, researchers, software developers

Track	Session	When	Min	Format	Platform	Domain	Stack Level	Category	Depth	Novelty	Audience
General Track	How to Build Long-Lasting Tech Communities That Thrive — A Playbook	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	30	Talk	Cross-platform	Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	4	community organizers, software developers, business people
General Track	Optimizing Performance of GUIs	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	30	Talk	Embedded;Desktop	Industry	Frameworks/Middleware	Software	7	6	software developers, professionals
General Track	FQ-PIE: Contributing to Open Standards by Contributing to FOSS	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	15	Lightning Talk	Web	Research;Community	Frameworks/Middleware	Software	6	6	researchers, software developers
General Track	Mapping India in seconds, for one and all	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	15	Lightning Talk	Web	Government;Research	Application	Data	6	7	government employees, researchers, software developers
General Track	FOSS for the Forgotten Middle: Open-Sourcing Finance Software for India's 50,000 Microgyms	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 2 · 14:00	30	Talk	Web	Industry	Application	Software	5	4	business people, software developers
General Track	Navigating the FOSS Contribution Journey	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 2 · 14:00	30	Talk	Cross-platform	Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	3	graduate/master students, software developers
General Track	How FOSS and AI are Changing Government Workflows at NHAI	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 2 · 14:00	30	Talk	Web	Government	Application	Software	6	7	government employees, software developers, professionals
General Track	Offline-first mobile apps on Frappe: a metadata-driven Flutter SDK with server-side control	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 2 · 14:00	30	Talk	Mobile	Industry	Frameworks/Middleware;Application	Software	8	7	software developers, professionals
General Track	Physics at 60FPS	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 2 · 14:00	30	Talk	Cross-platform	Community;Industry	Libraries	Software	7	6	software developers, professionals
General Track	Do Open Source Companies Pay Competitively?	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 2 · 11:00	60	Birds of Feather(BoF)	Web	Industry	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	4	software developers, business people, professionals
General Track	FOSS and Co-operatives	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 2 · 14:30	60	Birds of Feather(BoF)	Cross-platform	Legal/Policy;Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	5	business people, software developers, social workers
General Track	FOSS4Good - Techies in the social sector	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 3 · 11:00	60	Birds of Feather(BoF)	Cross-platform	Not-for-Profit Sector;Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	4	social workers, software developers
General Track	FOSS in the Public Consciousness	Day 1 (26 Sep) Room 3 · 14:30	60	Birds of Feather(BoF)	Cross-platform	Community;Legal/Policy	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	3	4	software developers, social workers, business people
General Track	How India's Largest G2C Platform Migrated to FOSS and Broke Free from Oracle	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:45	30	Talk	Web	Government	Application	Software	7	6	government employees, software developers, professionals
General Track	How exactly can we teach students the right FOSS etiquette?	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:45	30	Talk	Cross-platform	Education/Academia;Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	5	educators/professors, graduate/master students, software developers
General Track	Seqout: search engine for the world's genomic data	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:45	30	Talk	Web	Research	Application	Data	8	7	researchers, software developers
General Track	How we build Community Projects from the Community for the Community	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:45	30	Talk	Web	Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	4	software developers, hackers
General Track	What can we do about open weight models enabling non consensual intimate imagery?	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:45	15	Lightning Talk	Web	Legal/Policy;Research	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	5	6	researchers, government employees, social workers
General Track	Opening the Archives: Building Digital Infrastructure for Public Participation in Archival Records	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:45	15	Lightning Talk	Web	Government;Not-for-Profit Sector	Application	Data	6	6	researchers, government employees, social workers
General Track	Flexibility is complexity in disguise: Building frappe-ui for 10+ Products	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 1 · 9:45	30	Talk	Web	Industry	Frameworks/Middleware;Libraries	Software	7	6	software developers, professionals

Track	Session	When	Min	Format	Platform	Domain	Stack Level	Category	Depth	Novelt y	Audience
General Track	The future of FOSS, SWE and Technical Education	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 1 · 14:30	60	Panel Discussion	Cross-platform	Education/Academia;Ind ustry	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Princ iples	4	6	educators/professors, software developers, professionals, graduate/master students
General Track	Don't Model Every Leaf: The Magic of Blender Geometry Nodes	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	15	Lightning Talk	Desktop	Community	Application	Software	4	4	designers, hackers
General Track	Property-based testing for UIs	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	15	Lightning Talk	Mobile;Web	Industry;Community	Application	Software	6	6	software developers, professionals
General Track	Surviving as an Open Source Startup : Xeneva	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	30	Talk	Embedded	Industry	Operating System;Kernel	Hardware	7	8	software developers, hackers, professionals
General Track	OpenTCAD: A FOSS Python Pipeline for Semiconductor Process and Device Simulation	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	15	Lightning Talk	Desktop	Research;Industry	Application	Hardware	8	8	researchers, software developers
General Track	Open, decentralized language assessment software for the public school system	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	15	Lightning Talk	Mobile;Web	Education/Academia;Not -for-Profit Sector	Application	Software	6	7	educators/professors, social workers, software developers
General Track	Computationalizing landscapes: The CoRE stack data structure for social-ecological diagnostics and planning	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	30	Talk	Web	Research;Government;N ot-for-Profit Sector	Application	Data	7	7	researchers, government employees, social workers
General Track	Bad Internet, Good Software	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	15	Lightning Talk	Desktop	Community	Application	Software	4	4	hackers, software developers
General Track	Open Standards in XR - A current overview of OpenXR and WebXR	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	15	Lightning Talk	Cross-platform	Industry;Community	Frameworks/Middle ware	Software	6	5	software developers, professionals
General Track	Freedom to code - Community's role in tech Policy	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 9:45	30	Talk	Cross-platform	Legal/Policy	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Princ iples	5	4	business people, government employees, social workers
General Track	Software Patents - AI and the Future of Open Innovation	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Web	Legal/Policy	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Princ iples	5	5	business people, software developers, government employees
General Track	Calibrate: A framework for continuously evaluating and improving AI agents within non-profits	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 14:00	30	Talk	Cross-platform	Not-for-Profit Sector;Industry	Frameworks/Middle ware	Software	7	7	software developers, professionals, social workers
General Track	Being Bayesian: Stress-testing India's Loudest Stories with FOSS & Open Data	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 14:00	30	Talk	Web	Research;Community	Application	Data	6	6	researchers, software developers, social workers
General Track	Building Open Source Digital Infrastructure for a University	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Web	Education/Academia	Application	Software	5	4	graduate/master students, software developers, educators/professors
General Track	Judiciary Entity Map: How open source can make India's courts legible	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 2 · 14:00	30	Talk	Web	Legal/Policy;Governmen t	Application	Data	7	7	researchers, government employees, social workers
General Track	Can We Build a Copyleft License for Community Data in the Age of AI	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 2 · 10:30	60	Birds of Feather(BoF)	Web;Data	Legal/Policy;Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Princ iples	5	7	researchers, business people, social workers
General Track	Micro-granting in India	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 2 · 11:30	60	Birds of Feather(BoF)	Cross-platform	Not-for-Profit Sector;Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Princ iples	2	3	social workers, business people
General Track	Community-Driven or Community-Branded? Who Gets to Shape Community Events?	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 2 · 14:30	60	Birds of Feather(BoF)	Cross-platform	Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Princ iples	2	3	software developers, social workers
General Track	Community-Centred Technology	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 3 · 10:30	60	Birds of Feather(BoF)	Web;Embedded	Not-for-Profit Sector;Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Princ iples	4	5	social workers, researchers
General Track	How do we scale and sustain AI adoption without burning the planet?	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 3 · 11:30	60	Birds of Feather(BoF)	Cross-platform	Legal/Policy;Not-for- Profit Sector	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Princ iples	4	5	business people, government employees, social workers

Track	Session	When	Min	Format	Platform	Domain	Stack Level	Category	Depth	Novelty	Audience
General Track	United by (Free) F&B – Food & Books	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 3 · 12:30	45	Birds of Feather(BoF)	Cross-platform	Community	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	1	1	community
General Track	FOSS for Justice — What can Open Source do for India's Courts?	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 3 · 14:30	60	Birds of Feather(BoF)	Web	Legal/Policy;Government	Application	Data	4	5	government employees, social workers, software developers
Hardware	Minnow: An Open Platform for Ground Swarm Robotics	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	25	Talk	Embedded/Hardware	Research;Education/Academia	Hardware;Firmware	Hardware	6	7	researchers, hackers, graduate/master students, educators/professors
Hardware	Build your own open source keyboard with ZMK/QMK	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	30	Talk	Embedded/Hardware	Community	Firmware	Hardware	5	4	hackers, software developers
Hardware	Building Open Source Music Hardware in India - Tarab Instruments	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	30	Talk	Embedded/Hardware	Community;Industry	Hardware	Hardware	5	6	hackers, professionals
Hardware	CNC4Everyone - How we built a CNC machine for every classroom, college and makerspace	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	30	Talk	Embedded/Hardware	Education/Academia	Hardware;Firmware	Hardware	6	6	educators/professors, hackers, graduate/master students
Hardware	My zero-to-hero journey deploying a fiber-optic and wireless community mesh	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	30	Talk	Embedded/Hardware	Community	Hardware;Application	Hardware	5	7	hackers, social workers
Hardware	HackerFab IITB: democratizing semiconductor fabrication	Day 1 (26 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	30	Talk	Hardware	Research;Education/Academia	Hardware	Hardware	8	9	researchers, graduate/master students, hackers
RTOS	Beyond Hardware Description: Using Device Tree for System-Level Configuration in Zephyr RTOS	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Embedded	Industry	Firmware;Operating System	Software	7	5	software developers, professionals
RTOS	From Display Controller to Panel: A Modular Display Pipeline Architecture for Zephyr	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Embedded	Industry	Firmware;Operating System	Software	8	7	software developers, professionals
RTOS	From Reset to main(): Porting Infineon TriCore AURIX to Zephyr	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	25	Talk	Embedded	Industry	Firmware;Operating System	Software	9	8	software developers, professionals, researchers
RTOS	Real-Time Video Pipelines on Embedded SoCs: A FreeRTOS Case Study	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Embedded	Industry	Firmware	Software	8	6	software developers, professionals
RTOS	Tackling core lifecycle management in heterogeneous SoCs	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Embedded	Industry	Firmware;Operating System	Software	8	7	software developers, professionals
RTOS	Loops to real time	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Embedded	Education/Academia	Firmware;Operating System	Software	3	2	graduate/master students, hackers, software developers
RTOS	Indigenous, High-Performance, Safety-Critical RTOS	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Embedded	Government;Industry	Operating System;Kernel	Software	8	8	professionals, researchers, government employees
RTOS	From Architecture to Tasks: Designing Real-Time MCU Firmware in Heterogeneous APU-MCU Systems	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Embedded	Industry	Firmware	Software	8	6	software developers, professionals
RTOS	Deterministic Vision: Offloading Real-Time Camera Pipelines to FreeRTOS on Heterogeneous SoCs	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Lightning Talk	Embedded	Industry	Firmware	Software	8	7	software developers, professionals
RTOS	RTL to Zephyr RTOS: Lightweight-Crypto Acceleration on Open RISC-V	Day 2 (27 Sep) Room 1 · 14:00	15	Talk	Embedded;Hardware	Research;Industry	Hardware;Firmware	Hardware	9	9	researchers, software developers, hackers
Security	Reverse Engineering the PAN QR Code	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	15	Lightning Talk	Mobile;Web	Government;Community	Application	Software	6	7	hackers, software developers, government employees
Security	When NO_PROXY Lies: Finding an IPv4-Mapped IPv6 Patch Bypass in Axios	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	15	Lightning Talk	Web	Industry;Community	Libraries	Software	7	6	software developers, professionals
Security	Extracting AES Keys from Embedded Devices Using Open Source Hardware	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	20	Lightning Talk	Embedded	Research;Industry	Hardware;Firmware	Hardware	7	6	hackers, researchers, professionals
Security	The Art of Userspace Sandboxing on Linux	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	25	Talk	Desktop	Industry;Community	Kernel;Operating System	Software	8	6	software developers, professionals, hackers

Track	Session	When	Min	Format	Platform	Domain	Stack Level	Category	Depth	Novelty	Audience
Security	Extending Capa for Malicious Script Analysis	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	15	Lightning Talk	Desktop	Community;Research	Libraries;Application	Software	7	6	software developers, researchers
Security	Keeping an Eye on your Eye: Disassembling and Reassembling Smart Camera Hardware to breach YOUR Security	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	30	Talk	Embedded	Community	Hardware;Firmware	Hardware	8	7	hackers, professionals
Security	Hacking India's Largest Exam System	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	15	Lightning Talk	Web	Government;Community	Application	Software	5	6	hackers, government employees, social workers
Security	Papers, Please: A First Look at Age Verification on the Web	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	25	Talk	Web	Research;Legal/Policy	Application	Data	7	7	researchers, government employees, professionals
Security	A plan to sort out this CVE mess	Day 2 (27 Sep) Hall 3 · 10:00	15	Lightning Talk	Web	Community;Industry	Application	Data	6	5	software developers, professionals, government employees
Workshops (Pre-Conference Day)	Getting Started with Qt	Pre-Conf. Day Workshop Venue	120	Workshop	Desktop;Cross-platform	Community;Education/Academia	Frameworks/Middle ware;Application	Software	5	3	software developers, hackers, graduate/master students
Workshops (Pre-Conference Day)	Making music with strudel.cc	Pre-Conf. Day Workshop Venue	120	Workshop	Web	Education/Academia;Community	Application	Software	3	6	hackers, designers, graduate/master students
Workshops (Pre-Conference Day)	Digital Security for Journalists, Activists, and Everyday Internet Users: A Hands-On FOSS Workshop	Pre-Conf. Day Workshop Venue	120	Workshop	Cross-platform	Not-for-Profit Sector;Community;Legal/Policy	Application	FOSS Philosophy/Principles	4	4	social workers, hackers, professionals
Workshops (Pre-Conference Day)	Fun and Profit with OCaml	Pre-Conf. Day Workshop Venue	120	Workshop	Cross-platform	Education/Academia;Research	Libraries;Application	Software	6	5	graduate/master students, software developers, researchers
Workshops (Pre-Conference Day)	Art - meet Math - meet Code	Pre-Conf. Day Workshop Venue	120	Workshop	Web	Education/Academia;Community	Application	Software	4	6	designers, educators/professors, hackers
Workshops (Pre-Conference Day)	Building AI agents end-to-end: A hands-on workshop	Pre-Conf. Day Workshop Venue	120	Workshop	Cross-platform	Industry;Community	Frameworks/Middle ware;Application	Software	7	7	software developers, professionals
Workshops (Pre-Conference Day)	Adding places to OpenStreetMap (outdoor workshop)	Pre-Conf. Day Workshop Venue	120	Workshop	Mobile	Community;Not-for-Profit Sector	Application	Data	3	3	hackers, social workers
Workshops (Pre-Conference Day)	Self-Hosting 101: A real-time self-hosting workshop	Pre-Conf. Day Workshop Venue	120	Workshop	Cloud/Server	Community	Application;Operating System	Software	5	4	hackers, software developers

Note on Methodology & Categorization

This report was produced by an AI assistant (Claude, by Anthropic) working through the conference's own source files, not by the IndiaFOSS 2026 programme committee. It is intended as an analytical starting point for programme review, not as an authoritative or final judgement on any session, speaker, or track.

How the session list was built

- Schedule extraction.** `if2026-schedule.ods` was parsed sheet-by-sheet (General Track plus the 8 devroom sheets, excluding the Food Breaks sheet). Day, hall and start-time values are only written on the first row of each schedule block in the source file, so they were forward-filled down subsequent rows within a block; the per-row `exclude` flag (General Track only) was applied per-row, not forward-filled, to avoid dropping unrelated sessions that merely followed an excluded one.
- Title matching.** Each session title was normalised (smart quotes, dashes and whitespace collapsed) and matched against `cfp-all.csv` to recover its CFP ID. All 129 main-programme sessions and all 8 pre-conference workshops matched an ID; nothing was matched by fuzzy/approximate title similarity.
- Proposal retrieval.** For every matched ID, the full public proposal page at `fossunited.org/c/indiafoss/2026/cfp/<ID>` was fetched and its "Session Description" and "Key Takeaways" fields were extracted as plain text. All scoring and tagging below was based on reading this original proposal text, not on the title alone.
- Workshops.** The 8 Workshop-type entries in `cfp-all.csv` do not appear in `if2026-schedule.ods` because they run on a separate pre-conference day; they were added to the dataset manually as a 10th track ("Workshops (Pre-Conference Day)") with an assumed uniform duration of 120 minutes each, per the stated ~2-hour format, since no individual start times were published for them.
- Curation attribution.** The report tags each gap/strength as "Programme Committee" (General Track, BoFs, Panels and the Workshop day) or "Independent devroom" (the 8 devrooms, each running its own internal review once selected). The named rejected proposals (Section 8 of the Detailed Overview — the "Tech Geopolitics and Policy" and "Building with Open Data in India" devrooms, the AI-focused panel pitches) come from three public FOSS United forum threads: the `call-for-devrooms-for-indiafoss-2026`, `propose-birds-of-a-feather-bof-session-indiafoss-2026`, and `call-for-panel-discussions-indiafoss-2026` threads. Those threads were read via an automated fetch-and-summarise tool, not parsed directly from the raw HTML, so treat the exact proposal counts and titles as a close paraphrase of the forum record rather than a verbatim transcript — worth a manual double-check against the live thread before quoting externally.
- Booths and sponsors (Section 9).** The 75-booth list at `fossunited.org/indiafoss/2026/booths` and the sponsor/community-partner logos at `fossunited.org/indiafoss/2026` were both read the same way (fetch-and-summarise, not raw HTML) and are treated separately from the session dataset throughout this report — neither booths nor sponsors are talks, so the `categories.md` schema (duration, depth, novelty) doesn't apply to them; booths are grouped only by informal theme (data, policy, hardware, etc.) to check against the session-level gaps, and sponsors are listed as-is with no scoring at all.
- Which devrooms are community-run vs. individual-run.** The distinction drawn in Section 1 and the gap analysis (Cloud & DevOps/Point Blank, Compilers/LLVM Social Bangalore, and Hardware/absurd.industries as community-run; AOSP as a borderline case via `aosp-devs.org`; Documentation & Technical Writing, RTOS, Security and Design as individual-organiser devrooms) was supplied as fact for this analysis rather than independently sourced by this report — the `fossunited.org/indiafoss/2026/devrooms` index page itself doesn't name managers or communities per devroom, so this detail couldn't be independently cross-checked from public pages alone within this session.
- Speaker counts and the producer-to-attendee ratio (Section 10).** The 157-unique-speaker figure was extracted directly from the "Speakers" field already present on each of the 137 cached session proposal pages (the same pages used for descriptions and depth/novelty scoring) — a fresh, exact parse of that field, not an estimate. The attendee statistics (2,383 total registrations, ticket tiers, gender and regional breakdowns) come from `fossunited.org/indiafoss/2026/stats` via the same fetch-and-summarise method as other forum/web sources in this report; the five named ticket tiers sum to roughly 32% short of the stated total, which the public dashboard doesn't explain, and regional percentages quoted here are this report's own calculation against the 2,383 total (the dashboard's own on-page percentages appear to use a different, unstated base and don't quite reconcile with the raw counts). The 150-booth-representative figure is a nominal ceiling (75 booths × 2 seats, per the stated staffing model), not a verified headcount, and cannot be de-duplicated against the speaker list — a person could plausibly hold both roles. Treat the "~307 producers" and "~13% of the room" figures as an informative upper bound, not a precise census.

How each session was classified

Every one of the 137 sessions was individually read and tagged by the AI assistant against the seven dimensions defined in `categories.md`:

- Platform, Domain, Level in Technology Stack** — assigned as one or more free-text tags per session (separated by " ; " in the data table), based on the technology and audience the proposal itself describes. A session can and often does carry more than one tag in each field.
- Overall category** — a single primary label (Hardware / Software / Data / FOSS Philosophy & Principles) chosen to reflect the proposal's centre of gravity, not every topic it touches.

- **Depth of technical coverage (1–10) and Novelty vs. existing work (1–10)** — judgement calls made by the AI assistant from the proposal text alone (scope, prerequisites assumed, specificity of implementation detail, and how the author frames the work's relationship to prior art). These were *not* derived from any objective external signal (e.g. citation counts, GitHub stars, speaker seniority) and should be read as one analyst's relative ranking across the programme, not an absolute or verified score.
- **Suitability for audience** — one or more audience tags from the `categories.md` list, inferred from who the proposal explicitly addresses or clearly assumes as background.

Where this analysis is most likely to be wrong

- Depth and novelty scores are subjective single-pass estimates from proposal text, not from watching the actual delivered talk — a strong speaker can make a "5/10 novelty" topic land as fresh, and a weak delivery can flatten a "9/10" one.
- Classification was done from the CFP abstract only; last-minute scope changes, co-speakers, or slide content that diverges from the original proposal are not reflected.
- Multi-tag fields (platform, domain, stack level, audience) reflect the assistant's reading of emphasis, which is inherently approximate for sessions that genuinely span several areas.
- The dataset reflects a single snapshot of `if2026-schedule.ods` and `cfp-all.csv` ; if the schedule changes after this report was generated, the numbers here will no longer match the live programme.

The full per-session table earlier in this report is provided precisely so that any individual classification can be checked against the linked original proposal and corrected by someone with direct knowledge of the talk.

Appendix: categories.md, verbatim, and how it maps to this report

Every classification in this report traces back to a single project file, `categories.md`, reproduced below exactly as written (including its two small typos — "Not-for-Profot" and "FOSS Philosphy/Principles" — left uncorrected because this is a verbatim quote, not a paraphrase).

CATEGORIES.MD — FULL TEXT

Use the following categories for classification:

- * Platform: embedded, mobile, desktop, web, etc
- * Domain: Education/Academia, Not-for-Profot Sector, Government, Research, Community, Industry, Legal/Policy, etc
- * Level in Technology Stack: Hardware, Firmware, Kernel, Operating System, Frameworks/Middleware, Libraries, Application, etc
- * Overall category: Hardware, Software, Data, FOSS Philosphy/Principles
- * Depth of technical coverage at Level: rated on a scale of 1 to 10
- * Novelty compared to existing work: rated on a scale of 1 to 10
- * Suitability for Audience: graduate/master level students, designers, hackers, professionals, researchers, software developers, educators/professors, social workers, government employees, venture capitalists, business people, etc

Each of the seven bullets became one column in the per-session table earlier in this report. The table below shows exactly how the free-form category definition was operationalised into a repeatable rule, and what this specific programme produced under that rule:

categories.md bullet	Report column	How it was applied	What this programme's 137 sessions show
Platform	column <code>platform</code>	The bullet gives four examples plus "etc.", so this was treated as an open list : one or more free-text tags per session, drawn from the given four plus natural extensions the source implies (Cross-platform, Cloud/Server, Hardware) where a proposal didn't fit cleanly into embedded/mobile/desktop/web alone.	Web 46 · Cross-platform 38 · Embedded 19 · Mobile 17 · Desktop 14 · Cloud/Server 10 · Embedded/Hardware 5 · Hardware 2 (session count; a session can carry >1 tag).
Domain	column <code>domain</code>	Also an open list ("etc."). The seven named domains (correcting "Not-for-Profot" to Not-for-Profit Sector) covered every session observed — no new domain values were needed.	Community 74 · Industry 57 · Research 27 · Education/Academia 19 · Not-for-Profit Sector 17 · Government 14 · Legal/Policy 13.
Level in Technology Stack	column <code>stack_level</code>	Open list ("etc."), but the six named levels (Hardware → Application) again covered every session; multiple levels per session were allowed where a talk genuinely spanned layers (e.g. a driver talk touching both Firmware and Operating System).	Application 91 · Frameworks/Middleware 20 · Firmware 17 · Operating System 16 · Libraries 12 · Hardware 9 · Kernel 7 (tag instances).
Overall category	column <code>overall_category</code>	The only bullet with a closed , exhaustive list and no "etc." — read as mutually exclusive, so exactly one value was chosen per session, reflecting its centre of gravity rather than every topic touched.	Software 75 sessions / 2,030 min · FOSS Philosphy/Principles 33 / 1,220 min · Data 16 / 520 min · Hardware 13 / 330 min.
Depth of technical coverage	column <code>depth</code>	Applied literally as a 1–10 integer, estimated from how much implementation detail, prerequisite knowledge, and specificity the proposal text itself demonstrates (see caveats above — this is a single-pass subjective read, not a verified score).	Mean 5.7/10 across all 137 sessions; highest by track: RTOS 7.6, Security 6.8; lowest: the Workshop day 4.6 and Documentation 4.5 (both accessible by design).

categories.md bullet	Report column	How it was applied	What this programme's 137 sessions show
Novelty vs. existing work	column novelty	Also a literal 1–10 integer, estimated from how the proposal itself frames its relationship to prior art, existing tools, or standard practice.	Mean 5.6/10; highest by track: RTOS and Hardware (6.5); lowest: the Workshop day (4.8), which is intentionally introductory.
Suitability for Audience	column audience	Like Platform/Domain/Stack, this bullet carries an "etc." , so its eleven named audiences were treated as a starting set, not a hard ceiling — a session could earn an audience tag beyond those eleven where none of them fit as precisely (used sparingly: 2 of 137 sessions).	software developers 98 · professionals 52 · researchers 38 · hackers 37 · social workers 32 · government employees 21 · graduate/master students 19 · educators/professors 13 · business people 13 · designers 10 · venture capitalists 0 · community 1 · community organizers 1 — the "etc." extensions, plus the one named audience nobody's proposal addressed.

Six of the seven bullets ("Platform", "Domain", "Level in Technology Stack", "Suitability for Audience", plus the two numeric ones) carry an "etc." or an open numeric scale; this report read "etc." as permission to tag more than one value per session and to extend the named examples where a session genuinely warranted it. **"Overall category" is the sole closed, exhaustive list** with no "etc.", which this report treated as a hard constraint — exactly one of its four values per session.